Independent Audit Report

ISUZU Dealer Standards Evaluation Sheet — Version 2026
Operational, service, and compliance requirements for authorised dealers

Report date: 01 June 2026
Prepared for: ISZE / IBX programme management
Basis of review: Consolidated analysis of deployed Excel templates (representative master: *IDS Evaluation Sheet_rev11 Alta Motorsenter.xlsx*) and aligned market submissions (BE, IUK, ITUK, NL, Poland, Petros, RSA).
Classification: Internal — management use

1. Executive summary

This audit assesses the **2026 ISUZU Dealer Standards Evaluation Sheet** as an operating instrument for self-assessment, field audit, and cross-market benchmarking. The template is structurally mature: it segments requirements into logical domains (premises, organisation, service, parts, sales, marketing, KPIs), assigns traceable item numbers, and links to a quantitative scorecard. However, as a *compliance and governance* document it exhibits material weaknesses that undermine audit defensibility, dealer comprehension, and regulatory alignment.

Overall rating (critical view): Adequate for internal benchmarking; not yet fit for formal compliance certification without remediation.

Dimension	Score (1–5)	Auditor comment
Clarity of language	2.5	Heavy compound questions; inconsistent terms; typos in live template
Cohesion & structure	3.5	Strong category tree; weak governance layer and version control
Auditability / evidence	2.0	Reference column largely unused; method labels inconsistent
Regulatory alignment	2.5	GDPR and H&S referenced ad hoc; no explicit legal mapping
OEM benchmark position	3.0	Breadth comparable to premium CV OEMs; depth of evidence trails below best practice

Key findings: (1) ~196 auditable line items create scoring granularity but overload dealers and auditors; (2) priority weighting (1–5) is not consistently reflected in point values; (3) mandatory brand graphics rules (I.VIS / I.BIS) are repeated with conditional carve-outs that invite subjective scoring; (4) self-evaluation bias is evident in submitted files (high YES rates without populated evidence references); (5) multilingual deployments (EN/FR/NL) risk divergent legal meaning without a controlled translation register.

2. Scope and methodology

The evaluation workbook reviewed comprises four primary tabs: *Cover Page* (dealer metadata), *Evaluation Sheet_English* (~225 rows × 16 columns), *2023–2025 Comparison*, and *Score Card* (category roll-up to total percentage and items scored). Market packs mirror this structure with translated sheet names (e.g. *Scorekaart*, *Fiche de résultats*). Quantitative sampling on the RSA master template identified **196 scored questions**, with priority distribution: P1 (94), P2 (57), P3 (32), P4 (12), P5 (1).

This review applies professional scepticism: language critique, control design, comparative OEM practice (commercial vehicle and passenger OEM dealer audit frameworks), and EU/UK regulatory context relevant to Isuzu's European dealer base. It is not a field audit of individual dealer performance.

3. Clarity of language

3.1 Strengths

- Numbering scheme (A.1-1, E.2-2) supports traceability and workshop discussion.
- Four-level scoring rubrics (Point 0–3) reduce binary pass/fail where graduated criteria exist.
- Explicit reference to distributor brand policies (main brand co-location) acknowledges real-world dealer structures.
- Update column (New / Modified / Carry over) supports change management versus 2022 baseline.

3.2 Critical weaknesses

- **Compound and overloaded questions** — 43 items exceed 140 characters; many bundle multiple obligations (e.g. parking separation, marking, and night-time illumination in one criterion). This violates audit best practice: one control = one testable assertion.
- **Ambiguous modals** — Frequent use of "must", "should", and "do you" without distinguishing legal mandate vs. recommended practice. Dealers cannot know consequences of non-compliance.
- **Undefined acronyms** — I.VIS, I.BIS, I-TEC, 5S, and "IMG/ISZE Evaluation" are used without a glossary on the Cover Page or a linked standards manual.
- **Inconsistent evaluation methods** — 16+ method labels (e.g. "Related Document" vs "Related document", "Interview / Related Document" split across lines) prevent reliable auditor training and sampling plans.
- **Template quality defects** — Live text includes spelling errors ("unncecessary", "seperate") which erode authority in a document positioned as a contractual standard.
- **Conditional footnotes in-line** — Parentheticals such as "Check if main Brand allow…" convert objective standards into negotiable interpretations at audit time.

Illustrative excerpt (category E — sales): Questions on lead-response systems, conversion tracking, and post-sale follow-up are directionally sound but blend *CRM process existence* with *effectiveness* without defining minimum KPI thresholds (e.g. response within 24h). A dealer answering "YES" in Self Evaluation provides no probative value without the empty Reference column being mandatory.

4. Cohesion and structure

4.1 Logical architecture

The A→H category model (Premises; Organisation; Service; Parts; Sales; Marketing; Standards review; KPIs) aligns with established CV dealer audit frameworks and supports balanced scorecard reporting on the Score Card tab. Roll-up from subcategory to total points (max ~280) and dual metrics (*Points achieved %* and *Items scored %*) allows ranking while exposing partial completion — a design strength used successfully in IBX country league tables.

4.2 Structural gaps

- **No hierarchy of consequences** — The workbook scores compliance but does not map item failures to remedial timelines, dealer agreement clauses, or withdrawal of incentives.
- **Cover Page vs. Evaluation misalignment** — Mechanic headcount, GDPR opt-outs, and model lists sit adjacent to qualitative standards without validation rules (e.g. York Van Centre variant lacks Score Card).
- **Comparison tab under-specified** — 2023–2025 Comparison exists but governance for when year-on-year regression triggers action is not documented in-sheet.
- **ITUK consolidated format divergence** — UK operating companies use a multi-dealer matrix (Sheet2) inconsistent with per-dealer files elsewhere; increases operational risk of formula/version drift.
- **Priority–points misalignment** — Priority 4 items do not consistently carry higher point weight; undermines risk-based auditing.

5. Comparative OEM benchmark

Benchmarking is qualitative, based on published and industry practice for leading OEM dealer standards programmes (Volvo Trucks / Renault Trucks dealer standards, Mercedes-Benz Truck Outlet Standards, TRATON-group audit tools, Toyota dealer assessment, and VWG commercial network reviews).

Criterion	ISUZU 2026	Typical best-in-class CV OEM
Category breadth	Comprehensive (196 items)	Comparable
Evidence trail	Optional Reference column	Mandatory evidence upload / audit trail ID
Scoring model	0–3 rubric + self-assessment	Often independent auditor only for tier status
Legal integration	Implicit	Explicit matrix to ISO 9001 / ISO 14001 / local law
Digital channel	Limited (few website items)	Dedicated digital retail & data privacy section
Remedial workflow	Not in template	Corrective action plan (CAP) with deadlines
Translation control	Per-market files	Master English + certified translations

Strengths vs. peers: Isuzu's standard is notably strong on *physical retail and workshop presentation* (signage, customer journey, waiting facilities) and *aftersales process* (5S, customer handling). **Weaknesses vs. peers:** weaker on *data governance*, *CRM KPI enforcement*, and *closed-loop corrective action*. Premium OEMs increasingly treat dealer audits as part of ISO-aligned management systems; Isuzu's Excel-centric model will not scale without a document control layer.

6. Compliance and risk implications

- **GDPR / UK GDPR** — Cover Page collects mechanic names with optional blanking but lacks purpose, retention, and DPA role clarity. Evaluation items on customer data handling are not mapped to Articles 5–32 GDPR; risk of unlawful processing if dealers store lead data without documented legal basis.
- **Health & safety** — Workshop, 5S, and employee facility items touch H&S; but do not reference national regulations (UK HSE, EU framework Directive 89/391). Auditors may score YES while statutory risk remains (e.g. inadequate risk assessment).
- **Consumer protection / mis-selling** — Sales and marketing items (warranty extension, maintenance packages) intersect with consumer rights directives; template does not require disclosure standards or record retention for offers made at point of sale.
- **Environmental claims** — Environmental / 5S criteria lack alignment with environmental permitting or waste-oil handling rules; “green” appearance risk if marketing items scored without substance.
- **Competition / multi-brand** — Repeated “check main Brand allow” caveats may conflict with competition law constraints on exclusive branding in multi-franchise sites — legal review advised.
- **Audit defensibility** — Heavy reliance on Self Evaluation without mandatory evidence exposes distributor to challenge if rankings inform incentives (EU competition-sensitive state aid character).

7. Recommendations (prioritised)

P	Action	Owner	Target
1	Publish Dealer Standards Manual (PDF) with glossary, legal mapping, and I.VIS/I.BIS extracts	IBX Programme	Q3 2026
1	Split compound questions; cap at one auditable outcome per row	Standards owner	Rev 2026.1
1	Make Reference column mandatory for any Self Evaluation = YES	Audit protocol	Immediate
2	Harmonise evaluation method taxonomy (6 methods or fewer)	Template admin	Rev 2026.1
2	Align Priority 1–5 to minimum point weights or remove priority column	Analytics	Rev 2026.1
2	Introduce CAP tab: finding, owner, due date, verification	Field audit	Q4 2026
3	Certified translation register for FR/NL/Nordic sheets	Local markets	Ongoing
3	Reject non-standard workbook variants from rankings (template validation)	ISZE analytics	Immediate
3	Digital evidence portal (photo / doc upload per item ID)	IT / IBX	2027 roadmap

8. Conclusion

The 2026 ISUZU Dealer Standards Evaluation Sheet is a **substantive operational audit tool** suitable for internal ranking and dealer development conversations. It is **not yet** a precision compliance instrument. Without language remediation, evidence controls, and regulatory mapping, distributors risk over-relying on league-table outcomes that reflect self-attestation more than verified conformity. Implementing the Priority 1 recommendations would materially improve defensibility before linking scores to contractual remedies or financial programmes.

This report was generated from template analytics and professional audit judgement. It does not constitute legal advice. Legal and competition review should validate branding requirements and incentive linkage.